

THE MR. PRESIDENT

Success Rate	.0000000001%
Attracts	Beltway babes, voters
Requirements	firm handshake, white teeth, 270 electoral votes
Prep Time	at least thirty-five years
Bummers	• kissing babies • appearing faithful • campaigning is a real bear

THE PLAY

1. Win a local office and skyrocket to state representative by opposing the incumbent closest to death.
2. Become governor and cling to a primarily populist agenda but throw a little pork to the fat cats by luring at least one major corporation into the state. Balance yourself politically by taking a hard-line stance on the death penalty while quietly cutting funding for executions. If the economy is up, take credit. If the economy is down, blame the legislature or, if you're in a border state, illegal immigrants.
3. After two terms begin campaigning for president. Generate a progressive platform that panders to your party's extremes but can seamlessly convert to a more centrist stance after the primaries. Sink your money into Iowa and New Hampshire, make an

appearance in South Carolina and Nevada, and set up camp in Missouri and New Jersey if you still need Super Tuesday to win the nomination.

4. If you're not from the South, choose a running mate who is. It's also time to pick a theme song. Anything by Fleetwood Mac will do as long as it's not "Little Lies," "Landslide," or "Rhianon" because that would just be weird.
5. Visit a military base, throw out a first pitch without bouncing it over the plate, and do at least one photo shoot where you're wearing a construction helmet. Promise to run a clean campaign but have your running mate take potshots at the opponent with patronizingly down-home colloquialisms like "that's not how we run things on the farm" or "that's not the Main Street I know" or "where I'm from that's called cooking your grits before the gamecock warbles."
6. Win an absolute majority of electoral votes or a Supreme Court runoff and confidently yet solemnly take the oath of office—this is a serious responsibility.
7. Start banging chicks.

WHY DOES THIS WORK?

Women are drawn to power and you can't get more powerful than the president without owning a major media conglomerate. While we all think of Kennedy and Clinton as the preeminent Oval Office lotharios, it was Franklin Roosevelt who really exploited the position. Not only did he feign polio and confine himself to a wheelchair in order to generate a "wounded bird" attraction to complement his commander-in-chief allure, but he was also the only president to serve more than two terms. The country hadn't seen that sort of commitment to booty since James "Poke" Polk.